

UI/UX Design Fundamentals — Statement of Reasons (Part 5)

Project: Nordlicht Versand GmbH — Returns Registration (*Rücksendung*)

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1. Design Decisions & Course Principles

Structure Decision (Progressive Disclosure)

- **Decision:** Divided the returns registration flow into 4 steps (**SCR-01_ItemSelection** → **SCR-02_ReasonUpload** → **SCR-03_Summary** → **SCR-04_Confirmation**).
- **Justification & Principle:** Applied **Hick's Law** and the principle of **Progressive Disclosure**. By breaking the complex returns task into bite-sized screens, cognitive load is minimized for mobile users on the go. Users are presented only with information relevant to their immediate sub-task, reducing decision fatigue and potential input errors.

Form Decision (Proximity & Error Prevention)

- **Decision:** Placed dynamic conditional logic (photo upload drop zone) directly below the "Select Return Reason" selection box, accompanied by inline field error messaging during failed submissions.
- **Justification & Principle:** Applied the **Gestalt Law of Proximity** and **Shneiderman's Golden Rules of Interface Design** (Error Prevention and Informative Feedback). Grouping the conditional upload box directly beneath the trigger field ensures users immediately recognize the causal link between selecting "Item is damaged" (*Artikel beschädigt*) and providing photo proof. Inline error messages positioned directly at the affected inputs allow users to fix errors without hunting across the screen.

Design & Visual Hierarchy Decision (Isolation Effect & Single Primary Action)

- **Decision:** Implemented strictly one primary button per screen positioned at the bottom.
- **Justification & Principle:** Applied the **von Restorff Effect (Isolation Effect)**. Distinctly isolating the single primary action ensures high visual dominance, making the intended user path unambiguous on mobile viewports.

2. Documented Assumptions

Since specific business rules were omitted from the brief, the following assumptions were explicitly documented and incorporated into the design:

1. **Digital Return Method:** Assumed that after registration, Nordlicht Versand provides both a downloadable PDF label and a mobile QR code (e.g., DHL/DPD return drop-off). Users are not required to print labels if they choose the QR option on mobile.
2. **30-Day Policy Boundary:** Assumed the 30-day window is calculated automatically from the verified package delivery date. Orders older than 30 days trigger an automated route redirecting users to a goodwill review request (*Kulanzanfrage*).

3. **Photo Upload Specifications:** Assumed users must upload at least one JPG or PNG photo (maximum 10 MB per file) when "Item is damaged" (*Artikel beschädigt*) is chosen.
4. **Partial Order Processing:** Assumed users can select individual items from multi-item orders while leaving non-returned items unaffected in their account history.

3. Conscious Deviations from Course Recommendations

- **Decision / Statement:** No deviations were made from course recommendations.
- **Details:** All core specifications—including strict use of an 8px spatial grid, 4-column layout grids, 100% tokenized typography and color variables (no hardcoded values), explicit input field states, auto layout vertical/horizontal stackings, and strict grayscale wireframing—were followed in complete alignment with course guidelines.

4. Sources & External Materials

All external assets used in the design are open-source and free for educational/commercial use:

- **Icons:** Icons from Lucide.dev — used for navigation arrows, checkmarks, photo upload symbols, and alert indicators, etc.
- **Sample Imagery:** Unsplash (Unsplash License) — sample product thumbnail images for clothing items used strictly within wireframes and high-fidelity mockups.
- **Profile picture** - <https://www.everypixel.com/image-15600654595973076820>
- **Sitemap** - <https://www.figma.com/design/xmqUjsqAVgxz3uqbVfJTcl/%25F0%259F%2597%2582%25EF%25B8%258F--Figma-Sitemap-Generator--Community-?node-id=1-94&t=581KxEk52jxpFuoJ-0>
- **Persona template reference and icon** - <https://www.figma.com/community/file/881830156311997001/user-persona-template>